

Five reasons why men WATCH PORN

■ It's like buying a ticket to see a football or cricket match. What's your contribution? Nilch. Just sit back, watch, and fantasise.

■ Breaking the rules is always thrilling. In India, watching porn isn't socially accepted. Let's face it, no family will discuss it over dinner. Doing what you're told not to makes it all the more exciting.

■ Celebrity porn is the highest form of entertainment. You get to see someone you have obsessed about getting their kit off. Seemingly just for you.

■ We are born voyeurs. When I was growing up in Delhi, a couple of friends lived in a DDA society and if there was a fight, all activity would cease until every word was ingested and then discussed over dinner. This is what shows like *Big Boss* are based on. They follow the peep-hole theory. People spend 18 to 20 hours in a day looking at people through it.

■ Pornography is intrinsic to the psyche of man. It's inherent to his naughty nature.

by **Cyrus Sahukar**
The writer is a VJ with MTV.

Does your partner approve of your watching porn?

YES **49**

NO **33**

Forced her/him **6** Doesn't know **12**

Male 47. Female 55

Male 33. Female 32

Male 7. Female 4 Male 13. Female 9

For 2,661 respondents of the total of 5,353 who say they have watched pornography.
All figures in per cent



Where did you first watch a pornographic film?

		Male	Female
In school	7	8	4
With colleagues	6	6	7
With friends	65	74	41
I downloaded it	3	2	4
I bought it	5	4	7
My relatives showed it to me	7	5	15
I discovered it at home	7	1	22

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Whom do you watch porn with?

		Male	Female
With partner	40	37	49
With friends	47	53	32
Alone	13	10	19

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There is a near equal split between print and video formats with one in every two porn-viewing man reporting either. Video porn finds the most patrons in Hyderabad (68 per cent). Its patrons in Ludhiana (65 per cent) and Jaipur (62 per cent), on the other hand, are partial to the print medium.

About a quarter of all porn-watching women in Jaipur and 16 per cent in Patna said they watched porn without letting their partners know. Women are learning fast, though they are new to this game. While men are introduced to porn in their teens, a majority of women come to it in their 20s. So while the men are split between watching porn and reading it in print, the women stick to watching.

Writer and publisher Urvashi Butalia sees this is a combination of curiosity and experimentation which is not restricted to the

privileged classes. "Technology has allowed women to indulge in their fantasies in private. There is no danger of being exposed in public." Indeed, there are no social avenues for women to watch porn without being shamed. It could also be a counter to what writer Rukmini Bhaya Nair calls the greatest post-modern emotion, boredom. "Ugly feelings like anxiety and tedium are usually countered by entering the domain of ugliness, of the forbidden." With three in five men approving of pornography and nearly three in four saying they have indulged in it, pornography